

“There is no doubt **we must ... move ...** to **readjust ... our overall relationship with Thieu.**”

DEPUTY NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISER ALEXANDER M. HAIG, CABLE TO HENRY KISSINGER, OCTOBER 4, 1972

POLITICIAN 1911–90

LE DUC THO

Born Phan Dinh Khai, Le Duc Tho was one of the founders of the Indochinese Communist Party. He fought against the French during the 1930s and 1940s. The key negotiator for North Vietnam in the peace talks that led to the 1973 Peace Accords, he refused the Nobel Peace Prize he was offered jointly with Henry Kissinger.



» AFTER

On December 13, 1972, Kissinger recommended that Nixon approve massive bombing of North Vietnam.

DEMONSTRATING COMMITMENT

With the South unhappy with the terms of the draft agreement, Nixon was keen to demonstrate his commitment to the South. This reassurance took the form of **Operation Linebacker II**, an 11-day intensive bombing campaign against targets in Hanoi and Haiphong.

BACK TO THE TABLE

The Vietnamese returned to the negotiating table. A **ceasefire agreement** was signed on January 27, 1973.